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Editors
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Dear Editors,

Please consider my manuscript, “Speaking in Code: Surveillance and Coordinated Dissent in a Language-Based Global Game with LLM Agents,” for publication in the *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*.

The paper asks whether surveillance can suppress collective action through the communication channel alone. Field evidence shows that monitoring chills dissent, but it is difficult to separate direct deterrence from a communication channel in which citizens self-censor before others decide. I isolate that second channel in a controlled language implementation of the Morris–Shin regime-change global game played by LLM agents. Agents first reproduce the canonical threshold comparative static from prose private signals. Pre-play communication then turns private information into social information. When monitoring is added only to the sender-side communication prompt, leaving the receiver-side decision prompt unchanged and stateless, participation falls. The central result is a sender-side surveillance effect: surveilled messages leave information present but make it less usable for coordination.

The manuscript fits JEBO’s interest in economic behavior, organization, and simulation modeling. It combines a standard model of strategic complementarities with controlled language-mediated experiments, and it uses falsification, prompt-isolation, message-content, cross-task, cross-model, and replication-package checks to separate communication-channel effects from generic deterrence or text artifacts. The broader contribution is to show that censorship and surveillance need not be equivalent information-control instruments: censorship removes information from a channel, while surveillance can leave information in circulation but change its common-language form.

Sincerely,

Khaled Eltokhy